DAY 12 | PRE-READ

Showing the Right Thing

A light read before Day 12. About 15 minutes, no code required.

Prepared by **Ahmed** | linkedin.com/in/ahmed-al-imaad

Why read this?

Yesterday you built screens from components. Tomorrow those screens come alive with real data from your own API. You will also learn to show the right thing at the right moment: a spinner while waiting, a friendly message when something fails.

1. Screens change with the situation

A food delivery app shows a "Log in" button when you are logged out and your name when you are logged in. It shows "Your cart is empty" when there is nothing in it. Choosing what to show based on the data is called **conditional rendering**.

2. One template, many items

A shop with 500 products does not design 500 cards. It designs one card and repeats it for each product in the list. In React you take a list of data and turn each item into a component. Each item needs a unique label, called a **key**, so React can keep track of which card is which, like roll numbers in a class.

3. Waiting politely

Situation	What a good app shows
Data is on its way	A loading message or spinner
Something went wrong	A clear error and a way to try again
Nothing to show yet	A friendly empty message with a next step
Data has arrived	The actual content

Key idea: every screen has at least four states. Great apps design all four, not just the happy one.

4. Two halves of one app

The React screen runs in the user's browser. The FastAPI back end runs on a server. They talk by sending JSON messages over HTTP, exactly as you practised with Postman. Browsers are careful about which websites may talk to which servers; the server must say "yes, this website may call me". That permission is called **CORS**.

5. Think about these before class

- Find an app screen that shows a loading state. Was it helpful or annoying?
- What should a weather app show when there is no internet connection?
- Why might a browser refuse to let any website call any server?

Omotenashi (おもてなし): wholehearted hospitality, anticipating what the guest needs